

Virtual Consultenting

The Essentials:

- Laptop
- Good Quality Webcam
- Good Quality Microphone
- Good Lighting
- Green Screen or Nice Backdrop
- Zoom or Crankwheel
- Good internet connection
- Note Pad

Be prepared for anything!

Video production companies are always ready for anything, be prepared for something to go wrong just in case. Have a checklist to make sure you are ready to have a successful video conference.

Make sure your laptop is connected to an outlet or that you have enough charge to do your presentation. If your connection gets lost, you increase your chances of losing your sales call.

Don't leave anything to chance.

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Mute your notifications, put a do not disturb sign outside your door, place pets in a different room, and restart your computer before you start your call.

Know your video conferencing app whether it's zoom or Crankwheel get familiar with how to fully use the app so you're not lost trying to figure it out on the fly. Learn how to send the meeting invite, if there's a password or passcode to give, learn how to find it and send it to your prospect.

Sweat the small stuff, be over prepared, prepare for small talk, be ready to engage for pre meeting small talk. Know the names of the prospects that are going to be in the call.



Use the bathroom before your meeting, have a notepad, pen and water on hand before your meeting.

Physical appearance: Check your hair, teeth, nose, face and clothing. Always be video ready.

What to do: Keep it Visual, (Easy to see and read)
Tell your story with images, and limited texts.

Images make it easier for your audience to consume your virtual presentation. (Pictures are worth a 1000 words). The human brain processes information 6000 times faster than text. When making decisions they put more importance and trust on things they can easily remember.

Most impactful images:

- Full slide images with single sentence description either on slide or header.
- When including bullet points, no more than 5 bullet points per slide and keep it under 7 words per bullet point and include a large image on slide.



Show your face:

Many people don't like to show their face, but showing your face makes the presentation more personal, memorable and helps build trust. When you're sharing your screen use a picture option to show your face, so your face is always visible, even when screen sharing. When you pause to interact, get feedback, or pause to ask or answer questions, put your face back on the full screen.

Be Relevant:

Focus your presentation on their reasons to buy, avoid front loading your presentation about your company. This is the fastest way to a boring presentation. The secret is to talk about the prospect, and make the whole presentation about the prospect.

Be Brief:

In person it's easier to keep your prospects attention. Online or virtual presentations it's easier to get distracted to answer emails or look at their phones, The prospects attention span is shorter so it's easier to lose your prospect's attention. The temptation to multitask grows the longer your presentation lasts.



Structure and Practice:

Use the Solar Agenda to keep yourself on track, review what you're going to cover, tell them what you're going to tell them. Confirm that your prospect is ok with your agenda. Use "Parking Lot" to capture off topic issues or questions to remind you on track. Deliver the meat of the presentation, and summarize your key points, and finally gain agreement on next steps.

Be Interactive:

It's easier to be interactive with home owners in person, as compared to presenting virtually. Prospects tend to be quieter and give less feedback. The lack of interaction and feedback makes consultants nervous and they tend to talk faster. Interaction begins and ends with pace and pause, don't move too fast or too slow. Your speed should give your prospect the time they need to fully digest your key points. Pausing and checking is crucial in virtual presentations because you are not getting the visual cues that you normally would in an in person presentation. Checking keeps you connected to your prospect, it encourages feedback, and brings potential concerns to the surface. Pause after each slide or after key points within a slide to take prospect's temperature.



When presenting to more than one person, there may be one person asking a lot of questions and the other person might just be quiet in the background or maybe both parties are quiet. Most effective technique to get someone involved is to ask a question by name to the person. Check with everyone on the call at least once, use the information during the discovery call to frame your questions to fully address their concerns. Once prospects begin interacting, they continue to interact, once they are engaged your presentation will be more impactful.

"Does that make sense?"

"May I answer any questions about that?"

"It seems like that recommendation didn't hit the mark."

"It seems like you might have some concerns about a particular feature."

"How is my pace?"

"Am I moving too fast or too slow?"